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The New York Times



A billboard in Tehran depicting Iranian military personnel with captured U.S. aircraft and a message about the Strait of Hormuz.

Trump Revels in Making Emphatic Threats to Commit War Crimes

By EDWARD WONG

WASHINGTON — Power plants, desalination stations, oil wells, roads, bridges and other infrastructure.

They are the foundations of civilian life in Iran, and their destruction by American and Israeli forces would cause widespread suffering among the country's 93 million people — and in most cases would be considered a war crime under international law.

Yet President Trump has repeatedly threatened to do exactly that, with the aim of sending Iran “back to the Stone Ages, where they belong,” as he put it in a

speech on Wednesday.

On Easter weekend, he wrote online that “all Hell will reign down” on the Iranians unless they meet a deadline of Monday to make concessions or open up the Strait of Hormuz to ship traffic, adding, “Glory be to GOD!”

The president was emphatic about the targets in a follow-up post. “Tuesday will be Power Plant Day, and Bridge Day, all wrapped up in one, in Iran. There will be nothing like it!!!” he wrote. He cursed, mentioned Hell again and said, “Praise be to Allah.”

He is talking not just about civilian sites with military uses, which can be considered legitimate tar-

Words Could Galvanize Widespread Animus Against the U.S.

gets. In his speech on Wednesday, he said he would “hit each and every one” of the country's power plants, “probably simultaneously.” The next day, after the American military destroyed a large bridge near Tehran, Iran's capital, he exulted on social media: “Much more to follow!” At least 13 civilians were killed and 95 injured, an Iranian official said.

No other recent American president has talked so openly about committing potential war crimes, legal experts, historians and former U.S. officials say. Wartime American presidents and their aides have usually insisted they were trying to follow international and U.S. military law, even if they violated it in some cases.

International laws aimed at preventing the horrors of total war are codified in a series of agreements, including the Geneva Conventions, the Hague Conventions, the Nuremberg Principles and the United Nations Charter. Deliberate attacks on ci-

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Political Giving By Billionaires On Hush-Hush

By THEODORE SCHLEIFER and STEVEN RICH

Across America, there has been a remarkable shift in the type of people who fund politics.

The biggest thing is that they often aren't people at all.

The 10 largest individual donations so far in the midterm elections? They total almost \$300 million — and none of them came from a human being. Some of the origins can be deduced, but other checks came from a series of little-known nonprofits whose original donors will most likely never be known.

This is the new normal in American elections. Increasingly, individuals do not cut the big checks to political campaigns, donations in which their names would have to be disclosed to the Federal Election Commission or state regulators. They come from an alphabet soup of patriotic-sounding philanthropic organizations that send hundreds of millions of dollars to political action committees but do not have to disclose where the money came from.

So-called dark money is not new. But a review of new election filings and internal fund-raising documents obtained by The New York Times shows a stunning increase in the use of these shadowy philanthropic groups to raise money on behalf of candidates in federal elections. This is particularly true among Democrats, who have sharply escalated their reliance on them since 2020, far surpassing Republicans.

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A Beauty of a Bonnet

A colorful Easter tradition was on parade in front of St. Patrick's Cathedral on Sunday. Page A14.

Foreign Doctors Are Sidelined Amid a Shortage

By MIRIAM JORDAN

One Nigerian doctor performed knee and hip replacement surgeries at a New York teaching hospital. A Venezuelan physician treated people with diabetes and hypertension in rural Texas. A U.S.-trained ophthalmologist from Iran can no longer perform eye surgeries in Arkansas.

All three physicians have been forced to stop seeing patients after they were pushed out of their jobs because of a Trump administration policy that took effect in

Immigration Push May Disrupt Rural Care

January and froze visa extensions, work permits and green cards for citizens of 39 countries as well as people with Palestinian Authority travel documents.

The fallout of the move, which stemmed from a December travel ban, is expected to be most pronounced in rural areas that have long had a dearth of doctors, and

in communities with large populations of older Americans coping with chronic conditions. The disruption comes amid a broader immigration crackdown as the Trump administration has detained undocumented people, reduced refugee admissions and tightened visa scrutiny, among other measures.

“This was a big swipe at immigration without regard for particular categories of immigrants, like physicians, who are desperately needed,” said Andrew Wizner, a

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HOW U.S. MILITARY, RACING THE CLOCK, SAVED AN AIRMAN

NEWS ANALYSIS

Episode Leaves Both Sides Emboldened

By ERIKA SOLOMON

CAIRO — Iran's downing of an American fighter plane and the dramatic U.S. mission that followed to rescue a stranded airman provides both countries with fodder to claim a victory, but this chapter could end up propelling them toward further escalation.

Iranian state media on Sunday published photographs of a charred American aircraft and declared that the downing of three American aircraft in three days was a triumph of “divine grace.” Reposting the picture, Iran's hard-line speaker of Parliament, Mohammad Ghalibaf, said: “If the United States gets three more victories like this, it will be utterly ruined.”

From the U.S. perspective, President Trump also emerged emboldened, boasting on Sunday about how American forces were able to pull off a risky ground operation and issuing a crudely worded threat that he would begin striking infrastructure targets.

“Tuesday will be Power Plant Day, and Bridge Day, all wrapped up in one, in Iran. There will be nothing like it!!!,” Mr. Trump wrote. “Open the Fuckin' Strait, you crazy bastards, or you'll be living in Hell - JUST WATCH! Praise be to Allah. President DONALD J. TRUMP!”

Iran is now one day away from Mr. Trump's ultimatum to strike critical Iranian infrastructure if Tehran does not make a deal with Washington, or open the strategic strait. Attacking bridges or power plants, which could plunge Iran's population of more than 90 million into darkness, would constitute a war crime.

Washington's ally in the war, Israel, has already launched strikes on critical infrastructure, including a major pharmaceutical plant and its largest petrochemical complex.

Iran has warned it will retaliate by bombarding similar strategic assets in neighboring Gulf countries. Such escalation could be devastating for millions of civilians in the region, and wreak further havoc on the global economy and the already

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Account of Complex Mission After Iran Downed a Jet

This article is by **Greg Jaffe, Helene Cooper, Eric Schmitt and Julian E. Barnes.**

WASHINGTON — The two crew members ejected from their fighter jet just seconds after it was hit by Iranian fire. The F-15E Strike Eagle, the first fighter jet lost to enemy fire in the war, crashed violently to the ground.

The Air Force officers were deep in hostile territory on Friday morning, alone and armed only with pistols. The plane's pilot was in “constant communication” with his unit and rescued about six hours later by a force that included attack planes and helicopters that came under heavy fire, military officials said.



An image from a video of U.S. aircraft over Iran on Friday.

But the aircraft's weapons systems officer was missing. In the chaos of the ejection — a violent, lifesaving maneuver — he had become separated from the pilot, setting off a vast search that became the primary focus for the U.S. military troops and C.I.A. officers across the entire theater for two days.

This account of the weapons officer's fight for survival and rescue is based on interviews with about a dozen current and former military and administration officials, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss the sensitive operation.

Surveillance planes and drones

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SHARPER TONE President Trump escalated his threats to include hitting civilian targets if the Strait of Hormuz stayed closed. PAGE A7

Rights Versus Risks Debated As States Eye Raw Milk Sales

By ANEMONA HARTOCOLLIS

Robert F. Kennedy Jr., the health secretary, once declared that he drinks only raw milk. Earlier this year, at a state legislative hearing in Michigan, a Republican state representative, Matt Maddock, theatrically sipped from a glass of raw milk and declared, “There's few things in the world that are better than fresh milk.”

Raw milk was once a counter-culture cause; today it is supported by the federal government's top health official and the iron-pumping, vaccine-doubting Make America Healthy Again movement.

Republicans in Michigan and several other states are considering legislation that would make raw milk easier to obtain, despite warnings that it is dangerous to the public health.

Supporters attribute a litany of healthful properties to raw milk. They say it reduces asthma and



Cows ready for milking at a raw milk dairy in Rigby, Idaho.

allergies, cures lactose intolerance and builds the immune system — beliefs that the Food and Drug Administration, which Mr. Kennedy oversees as health secretary, calls on its website “misconceptions.”

The raw milk supporters have also aligned their arguments with a broader MAHA movement,

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Grown for Climate Change

Agronomists are unveiling a new apple, the Sunflare, which they say can withstand unpredictable weather. PAGE A9

A Vote for Patriarchy

A church's adherents are promoting household voting: One household, one vote — the husband's. PAGE A15

INTERNATIONAL A4-8

On Easter, Papal Plea for Peace

Pope Leo XIV's remarks followed a Palm Sunday homily in which he said that God rejected the prayers of “those who wage war.” PAGE A4

Dozens Dead in Haiti Massacre

Gangs tore through several rural communities, underscoring the challenges that will face the U.N.-backed force starting to enter the country. PAGE A8

Locking Down the Skies

The Chinese government tightened rules to curb what it described as illegal drone use, but some users say the changes are too restrictive. PAGE A5



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Replaced by What They Built

Employees in the tech industry are already having a taste of A.I.'s potential effects on the workplace. PAGE B1

Deal for Writers and Studios

With the entertainment business reeling during a period of rapid change, neither side wanted a standoff. PAGE B1

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The N.H.L.'s Gen Z Era

Macklin Celebrini and Connor Bedard are headlining a wave of talent that is remaking the league with flair and social media savvy. PAGE D1

OBITUARIES B5-6

A Curator of the Avant-Garde

Agosto Machado collected the New York ephemera of his friends and colleagues. As they began to die, he made shrines honoring them. PAGE B5

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John R. Bolton PAGE A16



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Fact-Checking ‘Hail Mary’

Based on hard science fiction, a genre that prioritizes scientific accuracy, the movie, above, gets a lot right but misses a few things, experts say. PAGE C1

